ATLASSIAN

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Atlassian appreciates the opportunity to share our perspectives to inform the forthcoming US Artificial Intelligence Action Plan (the "Plan").[1] Atlassian is an enterprise software company committed to helping teams work smarter and faster. Guided by our mission — to unleash the potential of every team — Atlassian delivers software solutions that drive productivity for organizations of all sizes. Today, over 300,000 enterprise teams globally utilize Atlassian products to enhance their collaboration, including 80% of Fortune 500 companies.

Atlassian has over one million monthly active users of our AI products. In this capacity, Atlassian plays the role of an AI "integrator" in that we combine, facilitate access to, and integrate AI models developed by third parties into our AI products. Indeed, our AI strategy has been built on a belief in multiple models from day one. This strategy allows us to swiftly realize the benefits of improvements in performance and costs of foundation models. In turn, we pass these benefits to our customers through results that are higher quality, faster, and lower cost.

Our Responsible Tech practices have helped us prepare for a complex regulatory environment. Our approach to AI is rooted in our Responsible Technology Principles, the framework we use internally to ensure we're being thoughtful about our development and use of new technology. Our Principles were heavily informed by, and designed to align with, a number of similar principles embedded in policy and regulatory frameworks globally. But they are also uniquely Atlassian. We drew on our company mission and values as well as our commitments to our customers, employees, and stakeholders.

In 2024, we published our No BS Guide to Responsible Tech Reviews, which describes our learnings from applying our template across Atlassian. By open-sourcing our principles, template, and sharing our lessons, we aim to encourage feedback and collaboration across stakeholder communities about the impacts of technology, and especially AI.

Our four recommendations reflect our role as a global technology provider. Like many other software companies, we face a constantly changing regulatory landscape. We are headquartered in Sydney, Australia and we have nearly 4,000 employees in the United States, which also is our largest market by revenue. In addition to national policies and legislation concerning AI emerging in Asia-Pacific and Europe's unfolding regulatory scheme under the AI Act, our operating environment is shaped by an increasing volume of regulatory determinations from relevant domains (e.g., privacy) and legislative bodies (e.g., US states) that address AI.

We believe the Plan presents an opportunity to impact international policy trends by presenting new ideas about: (1) actors in the AI value chain; (2) support for multi-model AI; (3) government procurement and use of AI; and (4) international partnerships to collaborate with like-minded partners on advancing AI adoption.

Recommendation 1: Enable policy frameworks that recognize the role of AI integrators in the AI value chain. The Plan should acknowledge the role that AI integrators play in bridging between foundation model providers, who sit at the top of the AI value chain and offer an increasingly commoditized product, and AI system deployers, who represent the last mile in

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delivering AI to their end users. Current policymaking processes focus mostly on whether an entity is a "developer" or a "deployer" of AI. However, many of the companies leading AI innovation, including ours, often do not develop their own AI models or have a direct relationship with the end-user consumer. Instead, these companies commonly occupy the role of an AI "integrator" – companies that combine, facilitate access to, and integrate AI models into products and services.

For the United States to reach its full potential in AI innovation, it is important that the Plan enables policy frameworks that expand on the developer-deployer framing. Indeed, AI systems are developed, integrated, combined, and deployed through a complex value chain in which multiple entities may make decisions that impact the safety or risk of the system. Accordingly, the Plan should recognize the unique role of integrators, and how US federal policy can enable the growth and thriving of this critical middle space in the AI value chain. One such area is the marketplace for foundation models, which serve as a core component of AI products that many integrators have brought to market.

Recommendation 2: Encourage growth in the marketplace for foundation models. The Plan should promote growth at the top of the AI value chain to ensure that AI integrators can choose from a broad range of performant foundation models and access reliable information about them. Atlassian relies on a multi-model strategy to deliver the best AI experience for our customers, and we leverage leading open source and proprietary models from different providers. We believe the industry will go through an explosion of new, cheaper, smaller foundation models. As such, our R&D investment is directed towards building our AI gateway to rapidly test, deploy, and productionize multiple models from multiple providers. This strategic approach allows us to swiftly realize the benefits of improvements in performance and costs of foundational models. In turn, we pass these benefits to our customers through results that are higher quality, faster, and lower cost.

As an AI integrator, the federal government's engagement in AI model evaluation provides valuable information to enable our assessment of models. For example, the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) plays an especially important role as a trusted authority on AI evaluation, including evaluations conducted in partnership with other national standards authorities. Likewise, NIST has served a central role in providing guidance and standards to support IT deployment across the federal enterprise. The Plan should reinforce NIST's continued role in these areas, as well as its broader contributions to the AI research community.

Recommendation 3: Facilitate AI adoption by government agencies by clarifying AI procurement and use policies. Government procurement and deployment of AI products should be a key priority for the Plan. The revision of OMB Memoranda M-24-10 and M-24-18 pursuant to Executive Order 14179 should reorient US government IT policy to facilitate broad adoption of AI. Given that the road to AI often runs through cloud services, a key corollary of this initiative should be reform of the FedRAMP authorization process to allow for expedited review of AI products so that they can be brought online to enhance FedRAMP authorized services, at least at the Low and Moderate levels.

The Plan should also position the US federal government to lead by example in its use of AI. Building on Executive Order 13960, the Plan should include a mechanism or process that enables the White House and the interagency policymaking process to understand and gain insight from years of data about agency-level utilization of AI. Additionally, consistent with the recently-enacted SHARE IT Act, the Plan should take into account that federal agencies involved in AI development will share their source code across agencies using code repositories, unlocking opportunities for government efficiency.

Recommendation 4: Invest in international partnerships to collaborate with like-minded partners and advance AI adoption. International collaboration on AI is a critical concern for Atlassian because of our global footprint. Today, our AI teams span countries and timezones, with core engineering work done in US and Australia. We believe strongly in the US-Australia partnership, given Australia's role as a major non-NATO ally, a partner to the US in the Quad and through AUKUS, and signatory to a free trade agreement with the US. Indeed, our company history – an Australian startup that grew into a US-domiciled, NASDAQ-listed company with thousands of employees across the US – is a testament to the power of US-Australia collaboration.

The Plan should advance the interoperability of policy and legal frameworks that enable companies to compete globally and reduce unnecessary compliance. Achieving this outcome depends on strong collaboration – both bilateral and multilateral – to shape globally interoperable approaches to AI risk management. For example, multilateral institutions continue their ongoing projects to develop governance frameworks for AI, including the G7 and the United Nations. The Plan should maintain a seat at the table in these dialogues with an eye towards mitigating burdensome requirements that limit innovation. The Plan should further promote the NIST AI Risk Management Framework in these forums, which would serve as a foundation for consistent, predictable benchmarks that ease implementation of AI governance.